nowadays, a rupee has no value. This fare reduction would have cost the railways ₹250 crore (US$ 58 million) and the passengers would hardly benefit. The Minister responded in typical colloquial fashion:

> *Hathua ki gwalan apna Dilli me nahi balki Siwan me bechati hai. Aur Hathua se Siwan ka kiraya maatr Saat rupaih hai.*
> (A milk vendor from Hathua—the minister's area in Bihar in eastern India—sells her milk not in Delhi, but in Siwan. And the train fare from Hathua to Siwan is just ₹7.)
>
> *Lagta hai ki air-conditioned office me rahne walon ko yeh ehsaas nahi hota ki ek garib gwalan ke liye ek rupaih ke kya kimat hoti hai.*
> (It seems that those who reside in air-conditioned offices do not realize what a rupee means to a poor milk vendor.)
>
> Further, the minister elaborated that it was likely that all the vendor's relatives lived within a 70-mile radius, and thus most of her work- and life-related train trips were within this small radius.
>
> This argument was persuasive and at the end of this exchange, the Railway Board agreed to a ₹1 fare reduction. [145]

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[138] 'Shunted Aside,' *Time Magazine* (Monday, 25 October 1971), http://content.time.com/time/magazine/article/0,9171,877315,00.html

[139] 'M.S. Gujral, 'Architect of Indian Railways' Great Turnaround,' *Avani, The Earth*, Journal of the Indian Railways Institute of Transport Management (July–September 2012), pp.7–8, http://www.iritm.indianrailways.gov.in/uploads/files/1345724978346-Newsletter-July%202012-Final.pdf

[140] https://www.indiatoday.in/magazine/economy/story/19830115-railway-minister-ghani-khan-choudhury-threatens-dismissal-of-railway-board-chairman-770358-2013-07-26

[141] http://indiatoday.intoday.in/story/railway-minister-ghani-khan-choudhury-sacks-railway-board-chairman-mohinder-singh-gujral/1/372312.html

[142] Menka Shivdasani and Raju Kane, 'The Beginnings', *Konkan Railway—A Dream Come True*, (KRCL, 1998), chap.20–21

[143] Khalasis are railway gangmen.

[144] Personal interview with B. Rajaram, detailing this aspect

[145] Shagun Mehrotra and Sudhir Kumar, 'Bankruptcy to Billions,' *Bankruptcy to Billions: How the Indian Railways Transformed* (Oxford University Press, 2009), p.1